

Student Help Tracking System — TA & Instructor Guide

Purpose

This sheet tracks student engagement based on how often they seek help. It provides a more accurate participation measure than attendance alone.

Each entry represents **one help interaction** between a student and a TA/instructor.

This data may be used to:

- Identify struggling students early
- Support participation grading
- Compare engagement across sections
- Improve teaching pacing

Sheet Overview

1) Help_Log (YOU USE THIS SHEET)

Where TAs record help interactions.

2) Student_Summary (READ ONLY)

Automatically calculates each student's engagement.

3) Dashboard (READ ONLY)

Instructor analytics view of the course.

Do NOT edit the Summary or Dashboard sheets.

How to Log Student Help (IMPORTANT)

After helping a student, add ONE new row in **Help_Log**.

Fill out the columns:

Column	What to Enter
Timestamp	Date help occurred
Student Name	Select from dropdown ONLY
Section	Student's section (1, 3, or 4)

Helped By Your name
Help Level 1 or 2 (see below)
Notes Optional short description

Help Level Definitions

Level 1 — Quick Help

Use when the interaction is short and simple.

Examples:

- Syntax clarification
- Small logic hint
- Quick concept reminder
- Less than ~2 minutes

Level 2 — Deep Help

Use when the student required significant assistance.

Examples:

- Debugging together
- Explaining a full concept
- Walking through an algorithm
- Multiple questions in one visit
- More than ~2 minutes

If a student asks multiple questions in one sitting → still ONE entry → choose Level 2.

Logging Rules (Very Important)

1. Log immediately after helping — do not wait
2. One visit = one row
3. Always select student from dropdown (no typing names)
4. Do not edit previous entries unless correcting mistakes
5. Do not change other sheets

Incorrect logging makes participation data unreliable.

What the System Measures

The system calculates a **Help Score**:

Level 1 = 1 point

Level 2 = 2 points

Higher score = higher engagement (or struggling student)

Engagement categories:

Score	Meaning
0	No engagement
1–2	Low
3–6	Moderate
7–12	Active
13+	Highly engaged

Why This Matters

Attendance does not show learning effort.

This system helps instructors:

- Identify silent struggling students
- Support grade disputes objectively
- Track office hour usage
- Detect difficult assignments

Important Notes

Do NOT modify:

- Student_Summary
- Dashboard
- Formulas
- Column headers

If something looks broken, notify the instructor instead of fixing it manually.

Thank you for logging consistently — accurate data helps support students better.